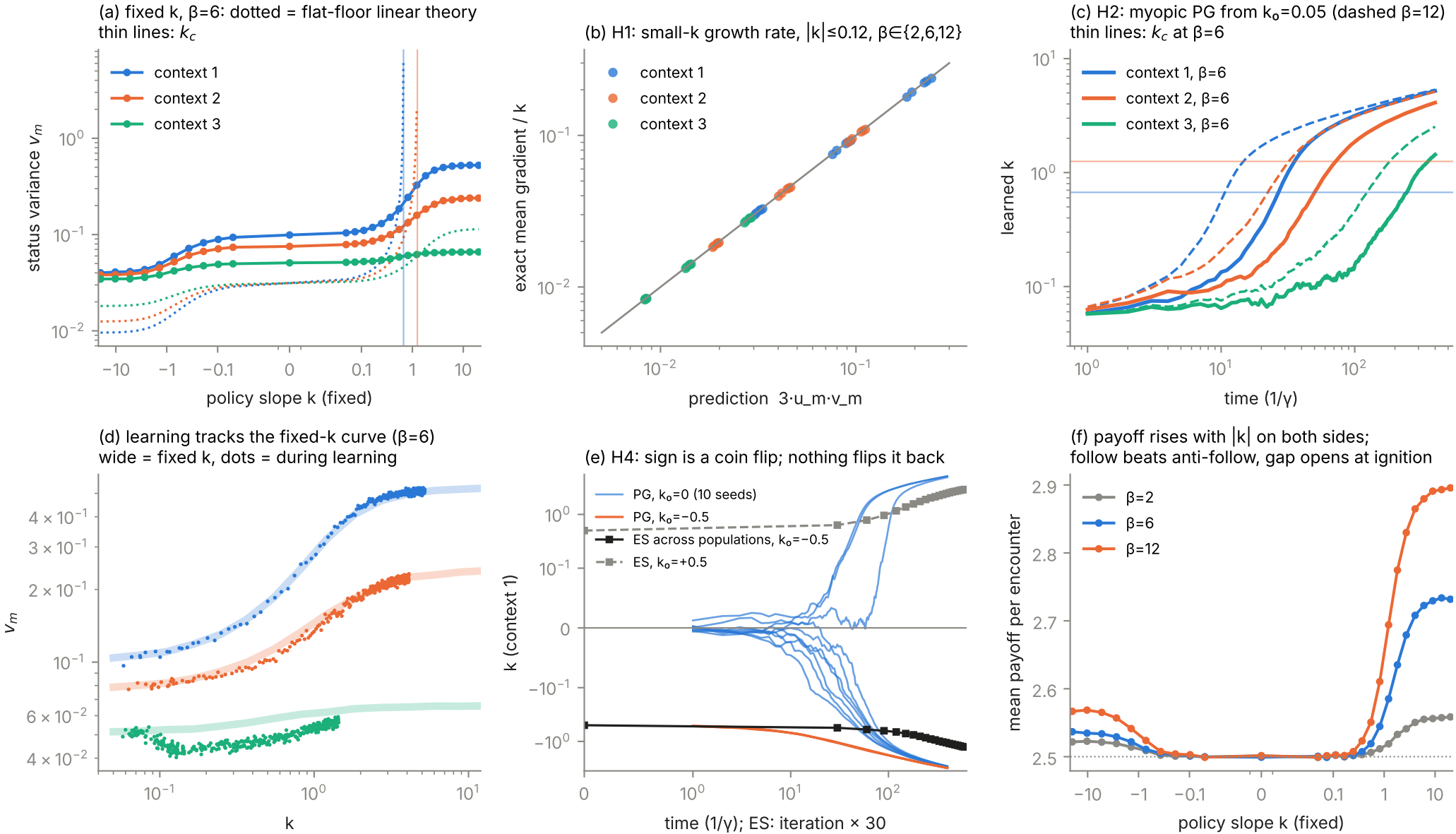

(a) fixed k, β=6: dotted = flat-floor linear theory
thin lines: k_c
context 1
context 2
context 3
status variance v_m
policy slope k (fixed)
(b) H1: small-k growth rate, |k|≤0.12, β∈{2,6,12}
exact mean gradient / k
prediction 3·u_m·v_m
(c) H2: myopic PG from k_o=0.05 (dashed β=12)
thin lines: k_c at β=6
context 1, β=6
context 2, β=6
context 3, β=6
learned k
time (1/γ)
(d) learning tracks the fixed-k curve (β=6)
wide = fixed k, dots = during learning
v_m
k
(e) H4: sign is a coin flip; nothing flips it back
PG, k_o=0 (10 seeds)
PG, k_o=−0.5
ES across populations, k_o=−0.5
ES, k_o=+0.5
k (context 1)
time (1/γ); ES: iteration × 30
(f) payoff rises with |k| on both sides;
follow beats anti-follow, gap opens at ignition
β=2
β=6
β=12
mean payoff per encounter
policy slope k (fixed)